



Meet Susan

Real World Experience, Common Sense Solutions



*"Trained as an engineer, I lead with common sense and practical problem-solving. Transparency and accountability are fundamental. I start with listening and work collaboratively to get to the right answer. That's my **common sense style of leadership.**"*

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Engineer

Susan earned two engineering degrees at Yale, built locomotives at General Electric, was a Fulbright Scholar in Africa, led environmental sustainability at Gensler, chaired the Maya Angelou School/See Forever Foundation board construction committee, and adaptively reused an abandoned public building for the SEED public boarding school campus in Southeast Washington, DC.

She has led change in organizations with only one employee to those with over 80,000; from urban U.S. school districts to national governments. Susan has served on national and regional nonprofit boards, including ChildTrends and GreenHOME. Her practical problem solving and experience inform her common sense leadership for all of Arlington.



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Executive

Following her executive roles at US Treasury and McKinsey, community leaders tapped Susan as interim CEO to steady regional affordable housing

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provider AHC. Susan knows what smart planning and accountability look like – we need her leadership to bring us together and get housing right.

Susan's small business, C2 Change Solutions, provides interim executive leadership to organizations navigating rapid change – from regional youth and housing nonprofits to national democracy organizations and mission-focused for-profits. Prior to election to the Arlington County Board in 2023, Susan was the interim Executive Director of Arlington Thrive (previously A.M.E.N.), providing emergency financial assistance to neighbors in need so they can be stable, secure and thrive in their jobs, health and homes.

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Mom

Susan and her husband Philip have lived in Arlington for over 25 years and are proud parents of two teenage daughters. Susan led the building planning committee for Dorothy Hamm Middle School, the Stratford Junior High historic interpretation, and Little Beginnings board. She also leads a Girl Scout troop and St. Mary's Episcopal Outreach and has served on sponsorship circles for newly arrived refugees, the Old Dominion/26th St Taskforce, the Donaldson Run Civic Association, and the Joint Facilities Advisory Commission (JFAC).

Susan attended public schools and grew up in rural Selinsgrove, PA, on the campus of Susquehanna University. Like many young professionals, Susan moved to an Arlington group house right after college. She has lived in National Landing, East Falls Church, Washington DC's Capitol Hill, and Donaldson Run, and worked in Arlington Mill, Bluemont, Clarendon-Courthouse, Green Valley, and Long Branch Creek.







*I have managed **billion dollar budgets**, planned and delivered **public facilities**, set tax and housing **policy**, and led **our** community through conflict and change to **shared success**. I will be a **leader for ALL of Arlington**, with **common sense, problem solving, and experience**.*

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Susan Cunningham

Arlington County Board Member



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Paid for by Susan for Arlington 2024, in Arlington, Virginia.

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